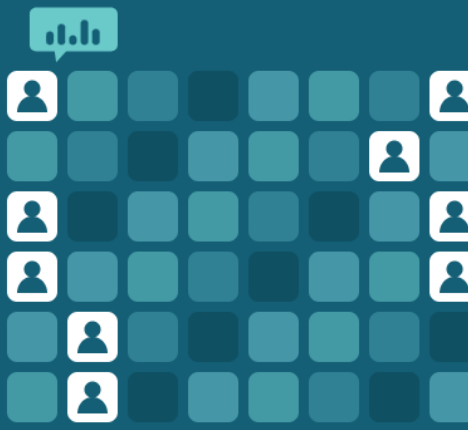
Place-based data training

Activities workbook

Module 2.2: Frameworks



This training brings together practical guidance for using data in place-based work. It draws on PLACE and Seer Data's work alongside place-based initiatives across Australia.

The training covers the journey many place-based initiatives go on – from finding and accessing data to sharing it, making sense of it with community and using it to support local decisions and action.

Who is it for?

It is designed for people working in or supporting place-based initiatives. You might be new to working with data or already using and managing data as part of your everyday rhythm.

How to use this workbook

Throughout the training, you'll find opportunities to reflect on your work and consider how the ideas and tools apply in your place or initiative. This workbook brings together the activities for this module.

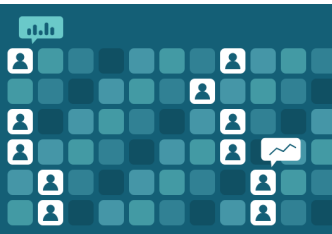
You can work through the training from beginning to end, or choose the modules most relevant to your role, experience and current work. We recommend starting with Welcome to place-based data training. You can return to other sections as you need them.

You can also connect with others doing the training to ask questions, share what you're learning and learn from their experience on PLACExCHANGE at **pxc.placeaustralia.org**.

A collaboration between

PLACE
Partnerships for Local Action & Community Empowerment

Seer
Data & Analytics



Community insights, data & stories

Module

2.2 Frameworks

Section 1	Choose and adapt a framework for your place	2 activities
Section 2	Agree on shared language and choose indicators people understand	2 activities
Section 3	Read numbers and community voice together	2 activities

Try this now: choose one framework for one piece of work

Apply Apply to your place 1

Pick a piece of work you are involved in right now: a project, a partnership, a plan, a report or a community initiative. Then fill in the table below.

1. Name the work, and the change it is trying to achieve.

2. Choose the framework that best connects that work to the outcomes you want to understand or influence. If none of the four fits, write “none” and name what you would use instead.

3. Write one reason it fits this work.

4. Write one thing the framework will not fully capture about your community, place or context.

This is the first line of your Framework and Indicator Fit Sheet, which you build across the module and could keep as a spreadsheet afterwards.

The piece of work	Framework chosen (Closing the Gap, ARACY Nest, Vital Signs, Measuring What Matters, or none)	One reason it fits this work	One thing it will not capture

Try this now: adapt the framework you chose

Apply Apply to your place 2

Go back to the framework you chose in the exercise “Try this now: choose one framework for one piece of work”, and localise it. You are doing Steps 2 and 3 above in miniature.

1. Find one indicator in that framework that already fits your work and write it down.

2. Write one local indicator you would add; focus on what is relevant to your work and community.

3. Name the role of one person you would ask to check whether that local indicator is the right one: an Elder, a youth worker, a school leader, a resident who has lived there a long time.

4. Note who would need to agree to it, since a local indicator that only your organisation uses is a preference rather than a shared measure.

One national indicator I would keep	One local indicator I would add	Whose role I would ask to check it	Who else would need to agree

Try this now: test three words you use often

Apply | Apply to your place 1

Take the same piece of work you chose in Section 1. Pick three terms that come up regularly, such as wellbeing, engagement, impact, outcomes or participation.

1. Write each term down, and next to it what you mean by it.

2. Name a partner or group who would define it differently, and how.

3. Write the version you would use in a room with community members in it.

Term	What I mean by it	Who would define it differently, and how	The version I would use with community members

Try this now: rewrite one indicator

Apply | Apply to your place 2

Choose one indicator already used in your work: a reporting measure, a funder's metric, something in a dashboard. Then rewrite it.

1. Write the indicator as it reads now, and the outcome it is meant to describe.

2. Rewrite it in the words a community member would use, keeping what it measures.

3. Ask: would this make sense to someone living in our community? Tick or cross.

4. Note anything the rewrite loses, because a plainer indicator that has quietly changed meaning is less useful than a technical one.

The indicator as it reads now	The outcome it is meant to describe	The community-friendly version	Makes sense to someone living here?	What the rewrite loses

Try this now: list the evidence you already hold

Apply Apply to your place 1

Stay with the same piece of work. This exercise is about what is already in your reach, not what you would collect in an ideal world.

1. Write two pieces of quantitative data you already have access to for this work.

2. Write two pieces of qualitative data you already hold: notes from a community session, something a resident said in a meeting, a service's observation, a survey comment.

3. For each column, write the one thing that this type of evidence cannot tell you here.

Keep any names, addresses or details that identify a person out of this table. What you want is what was said, not who said it.

Quantitative data I already have	Qualitative data I already have	What the numbers cannot tell me here	What the voices cannot tell me here

Try this now: write the strengths-based reading

Apply Apply to your place 2

Take one issue from the work you have been using in examples, and write the reading you would give it out loud. Four cells, one sentence each.

1. What the data shows.

2. What community members say.

3. What strength, relationship, asset or resource already exists here.

4. What new understanding emerges when both are considered together, and what it changes about what you would do next.

What the data shows	What community members say	What strength already exists	What changes when you read them together